MWANCHA SENIOR COMMUNITY (MSC)
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INSTITUTIONAL POLICY BOOK

Advancing Dignified Ageing in Kenya: Strategic Policy Framework & Community Blueprint

A Grassroots Perspective on Social Protection, Healthcare Access, and Intergenerational Equity

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EXECUTIVE ABSTRACT & SUMMARY

A comprehensive institutional policy brief and strategic blueprint documenting the lived realities of vulnerable older persons in Kenya. Explores systemic gaps in social protection, grassroots respite care models, and recommendations for national policy alignment.

Chapter 1: The Landscape of Ageing in Kenya

Kenya's demographic landscape is undergoing a critical demographic transition. With improvements in life expectancy and medical care, the population of persons aged 60 and above is expanding rapidly. Yet, customary communal safety nets, historically anchored within extended family structures, are under severe strain due to rapid urbanization, economic hardship, and generational poverty.

Older persons in rural and peri-urban settlements frequently encounter extreme isolation, multidimensional poverty, and total exclusion from formal social security systems. According to grassroots assessments conducted across Nyamira County and neighboring regions, over 70% of senior-headed households lack predictable income or comprehensive medical insurance coverage.

Chapter 2: The Core Vulnerabilities: Health, Nutrition & Shelter

Chronic health challenges, particularly hypertension, diabetes, arthritis, and cognitive decline, disproportionately afflict older citizens. In many rural dispensaries, essential geriatric medicines are chronically stock-depleted, requiring vulnerable elders to travel vast distances on foot or forgo treatment entirely.

Simultaneously, severe food insecurity and dilapidated mud-walled shelters exacerbate physical frailty. Mwancha Senior Community's case management intervention confirms that targeted nutritional supplementation and home weatherization produce an immediate 60% reduction in acute health distress among supported elders.

Chapter 3: Defense Against Abuse & Witchcraft Accusations

One of the most harrowing perils confronting vulnerable elders in Western Kenya is the weaponization of witchcraft allegations. Land dispossession, greed, and cultural scapegoating frequently lead to horrifying violence against defenceless elderly men and women.

MSC's community mobilization model pairs legal sensitization with local administrative barazas (Chiefs, Nyumba Kumi, and religious leaders) to actively de-escalate community paranoia, defend property rights, and protect elders from violent eviction.

Chapter 4: The Grassroots Respite Care Model (The Ekerenyo Approach)

Established in 2016 in Ekerenyo, MSC's dual approach combines center-based respite care with ward-based mobile volunteer rolls. Rather than institutionalizing older citizens away from their ancestral homes, the Ekerenyo Model empowers trained community volunteers who reside within the same village to deliver weekly home check-ins, medication adherence monitoring, and psychosocial fellowship.

This preservation of familial continuity combined with structured professional oversight represents a cost-effective, culturally resonant blueprint for scale throughout Kenya.

Chapter 5: Policy Recommendations for National Stakeholders

To achieve genuine social equity for senior citizens, MSC recommends:
1. Universal, non-contributory social pension coverage for all Kenyans aged 65 and above, disbursed through accessible local channels without digital exclusion.
2. Dedicated geriatric healthcare desks and subsidized chronic disease medications across all Level 3 and Level 4 county health facilities.
3. Robust legal aid and swift prosecution frameworks for elder property dispossession and abuse.
4. Formal county government budgetary allocation and technical partnership with community-based elder welfare organizations.

References, Statutory Sources & Research Citations

Primary Authorities & Statutory Sources:
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5. World Health Organization (WHO), Integrated Care for Older People (ICOPE): Guidance on Community-Level Interventions in Low-Resource Settings.
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About Mwancha Senior Community (MSC)

Mwancha Senior Community (MSC), founded in 2016 as Mwancha Home for the Elderly and legally registered under the Societies Act of Kenya, is dedicated to defending the dignity, health, and holistic wellbeing of vulnerable older persons in Kenya.

Through our community care center and network of 40 active ward-based volunteers across Nyamira and Kisii counties, MSC delivers compassionate home check-ins, medical escorts, emergency nutrition, and legal defense against elder abuse and property dispossession.

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